LAUNCHPOINT GROWTH

Business Continuity and Incident Response Plan

Maintaining and restoring essential business activities

A practical framework for IT outages, data loss, security incidents, operational disruptions, staff absences, and client service continuity.

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1. Purpose and Scope

This plan describes how LaunchPoint Growth will maintain or restore essential business activities when disruptions occur. It covers technology failures, data and security incidents, operational interruptions, unexpected staff absences, and impacts on client service. The goal is to protect client work, company data, and reputation while enabling a rapid, orderly return to normal operations.

The plan applies to all team members, contractors, and systems used to deliver sales, marketing, and client success services. It is designed for a lean consultancy and prioritizes practical steps over complex infrastructure assumptions.

Objectives

- Protect client deliverables, confidential information, and company systems.
- Restore critical activities within defined recovery time targets.
- Communicate clearly and promptly with the team, clients, and (where needed) partners.
- Assign clear ownership so decisions and actions are not delayed during an incident.
- Document lessons and improve resilience after every significant event.

2. Roles and Responsibilities

Clear ownership is essential during a disruption. The following roles apply for business continuity and incident response. In a small team, one person may hold more than one role; deputies should be pre-identified.

Role	Primary holder	Key responsibilities
Incident Lead	COO (or CEO if COO unavailable)	Declare incident level, coordinate response, approve external communications, close incident.
Technical / Systems Lead	Operations Coordinator (with specialist support as needed)	Assess IT/systems impact, restore access, manage backups and recovery steps.
Client Communications Lead	Head of Client Success (or Head of Sales for prospects)	Notify affected clients, manage service expectations, coordinate temporary workarounds.
Internal Communications	COO / designated Head	Keep the full team informed of status, next steps, and expected duration.
All team members	Everyone	Report incidents promptly, follow recovery instructions, protect credentials and data.

If the primary role holder is unavailable, the deputy (typically the next level up or a peer Head) assumes responsibility until the primary returns or a formal handover is completed.

3. Risk Categories and Impact Levels

Incidents are classified by type and impact so response effort matches severity.

Incident categories

- **IT / systems outage** — Loss of access to email, CRM, project tools, analytics, or ad platforms.
- **Data loss or corruption** — Accidental deletion, failed sync, or damaged files affecting client or company work.
- **Security incident** — Suspected or confirmed unauthorized access, phishing, malware, or credential compromise.
- **Operational disruption** — Power/internet failure at primary work location, major travel or infrastructure issues.
- **Staff absence** — Unexpected unavailability of key people (illness, emergency, departure) affecting delivery.
- **Client service interruption** — Inability to deliver scoped work or communicate on agreed timelines due to any of the above.

Impact levels

Level	Description	Typical response
Low	Single user or non-critical tool; workarounds available; no client deadline at risk.	Owner resolves; log for awareness. No formal incident declaration.
Medium	Team or client-facing tool affected; limited workaround; deadline within 48–72 hours at risk.	Incident Lead informed; recovery plan activated; internal update.
High	Multiple systems or people; no viable short-term workaround; client deliverables or data at risk.	Full response team; client notification; recovery priorities applied.
Critical	Security breach, widespread data loss, or prolonged inability to operate core services.	Immediate escalation to CEO; external support as needed; formal crisis communications.

4. Recovery Priorities and Critical Activities

When capacity is limited, work is restored in order of business criticality. Recovery Time Objective (RTO) is the target maximum time to restore the activity; Recovery Point Objective (RPO) is the maximum acceptable data loss (how far back a backup may be).

Priority	Activity / system	RTO	RPO	Rationale
P1	Secure access & credentials; stop active security threat	Immediate	N/A	Prevent further damage or exposure
P1	Client communication channels (email / primary contact method)	≤ 4 hours	≤ 1 hour	Maintain trust and manage expectations
P2	CRM and active client project files / workspaces	≤ 8 hours	≤ 24 hours	Delivery and pipeline continuity
P2	Core collaboration tools (docs, task management)	≤ 8 hours	≤ 24 hours	Team coordination and delivery
P3	Marketing platforms, analytics, ad accounts	≤ 24–48 hours	≤ 24 hours	Campaign continuity; less urgent than live delivery
P3	Internal reporting and non-urgent admin systems	≤ 72 hours	≤ 48 hours	Can wait until core service is stable

Critical people (in priority order for coverage): Client Success Manager(s) for active engagements, Senior Sales Consultant for open opportunities, then Marketing specialists supporting live campaigns. The Incident Lead ensures backup coverage is assigned when a critical person is absent.

5. IT Outages, Data Loss, and Security Incidents

5.1 IT and systems outages

Most of LaunchPoint Growth's work depends on cloud tools (email, CRM, document storage, project management, analytics, and advertising platforms). Response focuses on restoring access, using alternate channels, and protecting in-progress work.

- **Detect & report** — Any team member who cannot access a required system reports immediately to the Operations Coordinator and their functional Head (and Incident Lead if impact is Medium or higher).
- **Assess** — Technical/Systems Lead confirms scope (one user vs. company-wide), checks provider status pages, and identifies workarounds (mobile app, alternate browser, secondary account, offline drafts).
- **Contain impact** — Pause automated campaigns or scheduled sends if they risk error; switch client contact to phone/WhatsApp/LinkedIn if email is down.
- **Restore** — Follow provider recovery steps or restore from backup (see Section 9). Document time of outage and restoration.
- **Communicate** — Internal update within 1 hour of Medium+ outage; client updates if their work or communication is affected (see Section 8).

5.2 Data loss or corruption

- Stop further changes to the affected workspace or drive once loss is suspected.
- Check version history / recycle bin / trash in the relevant platform before restoring from backup.
- If recovery from platform history is not possible, restore from the most recent valid backup (RPO targets in Section 4).
- Verify integrity of restored files with the owner before resuming work.
- Log the event (what was lost, how far back recovery went, root cause if known) for the post-incident review.

5.3 Security incidents

Security incidents (phishing, suspected account takeover, malware, unauthorized access to client data) are treated as High or Critical until proven otherwise.

- **Immediate actions** — Change passwords for affected accounts; revoke active sessions; enable or verify MFA; disconnect compromised devices from shared resources.
- **Contain** — Isolate the threat; do not delete evidence that may be needed for investigation.
- **Assess exposure** — Determine what data or systems may have been accessed (especially client information).
- **Notify** — Incident Lead informs CEO; Client Communications Lead prepares notifications if client data may be involved; consider legal/regulatory obligations.
- **Recover & harden** — Restore clean access; review access rights; document and apply preventive measures.
- **External support** — Engage IT/security specialist or provider support when internal capability is insufficient.

6. Operational Disruptions and Staff Absences

6.1 Operational disruptions

Includes prolonged power or internet failure, inability to work from the usual location, or other infrastructure issues.

- Default operating model is remote-capable: critical tools are cloud-based and accessible from alternate locations or mobile devices.
- Team members should maintain a basic offline capability (local copies of active client notes where permitted, charged devices, mobile hotspot where available).
- If a shared workspace is unusable, the Incident Lead confirms everyone can work from home or an alternate site and redistributes any location-dependent tasks.
- Client-facing deadlines are reviewed within 4 hours; temporary scope or timeline adjustments are agreed with clients when necessary.

6.2 Unexpected employee absences

Key-person risk is managed through documentation, shared access, and designated backups.

- **Immediate coverage** — Functional Head (or COO) reassigns active client and pipeline work to a backup within the same day for critical absences.
- **Access** — Shared project workspaces and CRM records must not depend on a single personal account; use team drives and role-based access.
- **Handover pack** — Each role maintains a short “if I’m unavailable” note: active clients, open deadlines, login locations (not passwords), and preferred backup person.
- **Extended absence** — For absences beyond a few days, COO and relevant Head formalize coverage, update clients, and adjust capacity forecasts.
- **Sudden departure** — Access is revoked promptly; client relationships and work are reassigned; knowledge capture is prioritized in the first 48 hours.

7. Client Service Continuity

Client trust depends on continuity of delivery and communication even when internal systems or people are disrupted.

- **Known contacts** — Every active engagement has a primary and secondary LaunchPoint contact known to the client.
- **Service levels during disruption** — Aim to acknowledge client messages within the same business day even if full delivery is delayed; set clear revised expectations rather than going silent.
- **Workarounds** — Use alternate channels (phone, messaging apps, secondary email) and offline-capable deliverables (e.g., PDF exports) when primary tools are unavailable.
- **Scope and timeline** — Material delays are communicated proactively with options (reprioritize, extend timeline, or temporarily reduce scope).
- **Confidentiality** — Continuity measures must not weaken protection of client data; temporary tools are used only if they meet the same confidentiality standard or with client agreement.

8. Emergency Communications

Clear, timely communication reduces confusion and protects relationships. The Incident Lead (or delegate) owns the communication plan for each Medium+ incident.

Internal communications

- Primary channel: team chat / messaging group designated for urgent operational issues.
- Secondary: phone or SMS for High/Critical when chat may be affected or response is needed outside normal hours.
- First internal update: within 1 hour of declaring a Medium+ incident (what is known, what is being done, next update time).
- Subsequent updates: at agreed intervals until resolved; final “all clear” with brief summary.

Client and external communications

- Client Communications Lead drafts and sends updates to affected clients; Incident Lead approves High/Critical messages.
- Content principles: honest about impact, clear about next steps and timing, avoid speculation, protect security details that could aid attackers.
- Prospects in active sales processes are informed by Sales if their process or timeline is affected.
- External partners or vendors are contacted only as needed for recovery; no public statements without CEO approval.

Communication log

For Medium+ incidents, a simple log is kept (time, audience, channel, summary of message). This supports consistency and the post-incident review.

9. Backup and Recovery Procedures

LaunchPoint Growth relies primarily on cloud platforms that provide their own redundancy. The company adds lightweight controls so that critical work can be recovered within the RPO targets in Section 4.

Backup approach

- **Cloud platform retention** — Use built-in version history and trash retention (e.g., Google Drive / Microsoft 365 / equivalent) with retention periods that meet or exceed RPO for critical folders.
- **Critical client folders** — Active engagement workspaces are identified and checked periodically for correct sharing and retention settings.
- **CRM and pipeline data** — Regular exports or platform backups of core CRM data (contacts, opportunities, key notes) on a defined schedule (e.g., weekly), stored in a separate secure location.
- **Credentials and access** — Company-owned accounts and shared access are documented in a secure password manager; recovery codes and admin contacts are available to the Incident Lead and Technical Lead.
- **Local / device** — Team members avoid sole copies of critical work on a single laptop; work is saved to team cloud locations as the source of truth.

Recovery steps (general)

- 1. Confirm the recovery point (which backup or version is valid and how recent it is).
- 2. Restore to a clean location first when possible; verify content before overwriting live work.
- 3. Re-establish sharing and permissions so the right people can continue work.
- 4. Notify owners of restored assets and any known gaps (data between last backup and incident).
- 5. Record what was restored and any residual risk for the incident report.

Testing

At least once per year (or after major tool changes), the Technical/Systems Lead performs a sample restore of a non-production or secondary folder and a CRM export to confirm that backups are usable and that documented steps work. Results are noted in the plan review.

10. Incident Response Process

A simple, repeatable process is used for all Medium+ incidents so that response is consistent under pressure.

Step	Action	Owner
1. Detect & report	Anyone identifies an issue and reports it immediately via the designated urgent channel, with known facts only.	All staff
2. Triage	Classify category and impact level (Low / Medium / High / Critical). Decide whether to declare a formal incident.	Incident Lead
3. Contain	Stop further damage (e.g., revoke access, pause campaigns, isolate device). Protect people and data first.	Tech Lead / relevant Head
4. Assess & plan	Confirm scope, recovery options, and priority order. Assign actions and target times.	Incident Lead + team
5. Recover	Execute restore, workarounds, and coverage changes according to recovery priorities.	Assigned owners
6. Communicate	Internal and client updates at agreed intervals; final resolution message.	Comms Leads
7. Close & learn	Confirm services restored; write short incident summary; capture actions to prevent recurrence.	Incident Lead

Low-impact issues may skip formal declaration and close after step 5, but any security-related event is always triaged as at least Medium.

11. Testing, Maintenance, and Review

A plan that is never tested or updated becomes unreliable. LaunchPoint Growth treats this document as a living operational tool.

- **Annual review** — Full review of roles, contact lists, recovery priorities, and procedures at least once per year, or after a significant organizational or tooling change.
- **Post-incident review** — After every High or Critical incident (and selected Medium events), a short retrospective is held within two weeks: what happened, what worked, what to change.
- **Contact list check** — Emergency contacts and deputies are verified quarterly.
- **Backup restore test** — Sample restore performed at least annually (see Section 9).
- **Awareness** — New joiners are briefed on how to report incidents and where this plan is stored; team is reminded after major updates.

Ownership of keeping this plan current rests with the COO, with input from the Operations Coordinator and functional Heads.

12. Quick Reference – Contact and Escalation

Use this section during an active incident. Keep personal mobile numbers and alternate emails in the secure team directory (not only in this document).

Need	First contact	If unavailable
Declare / lead incident	COO	CEO
Systems / access / backup	Operations Coordinator	COO
Client impact & messages	Head of Client Success	Head of Sales / COO
Sales pipeline / prospects	Head of Sales	Senior Sales Consultant / COO
Marketing tools / campaigns	Head of Marketing	Marketing Strategist / COO
Security / data exposure	Incident Lead + CEO	External specialist as directed by CEO

Immediate checklist (first 30–60 minutes)

- Report the issue and known facts to the Incident Lead path above.
- If security-related: change critical passwords, revoke sessions, do not wipe evidence yet.
- If client-facing deadline is today/tomorrow: flag Client Communications Lead immediately.
- Identify one clear owner for the next recovery action and a time for the next status update.
- Write down start time and what was already tried — it saves time later.